

What the Submittal Data Tells Us About Install Dates

Findings from the submittal and release history, and what they mean for forecasting

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You asked whether we can extend Start Install dates past the last release — forecasting install timing for work still moving through submittals, before it becomes a release. We dug into the submittal and release history (about seven months, back to late October 2025: ~1,465 submittals and ~800 releases) to see what the data actually supports. Three findings.

FINDING 1

The For Construction → release hand-off is predictable

Once a submittal clears For Construction and closes out, its release lands on the Job Log right behind it — quickly and consistently. Across hundreds of submittals, only a single one took a messy, back-and-forth path; the rest were clean.



What this means: the moment a submittal clears For Construction, we can put a realistic release date on it and run it through the scheduling math the Job Log already uses — producing a projected Start Install date. That extends the install schedule past today's last release, covering everything currently sitting at For Construction.

FINDING 2

We don't yet record a submittal's stage as it advances

This is the reason we *can't* forecast the earlier stages yet — and it's worth being precise about, because it's fixable.

- Our system captures a submittal's stage **only once, when it first syncs in**, and never updates it as the submittal moves from Drafting Review to GC Approval to For Construction. The only

things we track changing over a submittal's life are its open/closed status and who currently holds it.

- Because of that, we have **no record of how long a submittal spends in each stage**. We can see that work is in the pipeline, but not how fast it's moving through the early steps — so we can't yet time-project a release date for anything before For Construction.
- Procore already has what we'd need: the live stage, and a **spec-section reference that stays with each submittal its whole life**. We're just not saving that history today.

FINDING 3 There's enough history to trust the For Construction number — and to start building the rest

The records reach back to late October 2025, which is what makes the ~3-day For Construction figure dependable rather than a small-sample guess. The same depth of history doesn't exist for the earlier stages, for the reason in Finding 2 — but the day we start recording stage changes, that history begins accumulating and the earlier stages become measurable the same way.

My recommendation

1. **Build the For Construction → Install forecast now.** It rests on a clean trigger and a steady ~3-day timing, and it works with the data we already capture. It immediately extends the install schedule to cover everything at For Construction, with dates we can stand behind.
2. **Start recording stage changes and the spec-section reference.** This one change is what unlocks forecasting the earlier stages — and it starts building the needed history from day one.
3. **Then extend the forecast up the pipeline.** After a few months of stage history, we can measure how long Drafting Review and GC Approval take and project install dates from the moment a submittal enters the pipeline — a true forward-looking schedule.

Suggested first step: I'll build the For Construction forecast against the live data so your team can gut-check the projected install dates, while we line up the stage-tracking change in parallel.